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LATAM BUSINESS GUIDE · 02 | OPPORTUNITIES

Business Opportunities in Latin America: Where to Grow in 2026–2027

A practical view of the region's growth drivers and a country-by-country analysis of Chile, Peru, Argentina, Colombia and Mexico for international B2B companies.

Latin America enters 2027 in a mixed but opportunity-rich position. Growth is moderate, the region is exposed to energy prices and global trade tensions, and several countries have just changed government. At the same time, the region holds a large share of the world's critical minerals, is a natural partner for Europe's energy transition, is rapidly digitizing and is attracting record investment in infrastructure, data centers and mining. For innovative foreign companies, the question is less whether to enter and more **where, with what offer and with which local partner**.

2.3%	2.5%	281M+	US$141B
IMF growth forecast for Latin America & Caribbean, 2026	IMF regional growth forecast, 2027	people in the five markets covered	investment pipeline under Argentina's RIGI regime

Regional opportunity drivers

Six structural trends create demand for foreign technology, products and know-how across the region, regardless of short-term economic cycles.

- **Energy transition and critical minerals.** Chile and Peru are the world's leading copper producers, and Chile and Argentina hold some of the largest lithium resources. Mining companies are investing in automation, decarbonization, water management and safety technology.
- **Nearshoring and advanced manufacturing.** Mexico remains the main manufacturing platform linked to North America, with growing demand for industrial automation, quality, logistics and supplier development.
- **Digital economy and fintech.** The region had more than 3,000 fintech companies by 2023, and instant-payment systems and digital wallets are reshaping how companies and consumers pay.
- **Data centers and cloud infrastructure.** Latin American colocation capacity grew about 20% in 2025 to roughly 1.1 GW, with further strong growth expected, creating demand for energy, cooling, security and services.
- **Infrastructure, logistics and ports.** New port capacity on the Pacific, energy grids and transport concessions require engineering, equipment and digital solutions.
- **Agrifood, aquaculture and water.** Agro-exports, salmon farming and water scarcity drive demand for precision agriculture, aquaculture technology, desalination and water efficiency.

Macroeconomic snapshot (IMF, October 2026)

Country	Population	GDP growth 2026	GDP growth 2027	Context
Mexico	130M	1.5%	1.8%	Largest Spanish-speaking market; USMCA under annual review
Colombia	52M	2.2%	2.3%	New government since August 2026; inflation near 6%
Argentina	46M	2.1%	3.5%	Pro-investment reforms; average inflation forecast at 32.5% in 2026
Peru	34M	3.0%	2.9%	Fastest-growing of the five; low inflation; new government since July 2026

Country	Population	GDP growth 2026	GDP growth 2027	Context
Chile	19M	0.6%	2.6%	Slowdown in 2026, rebound expected; pro-investment reform approved

Country analysis

CHILE Stable regional hub, reform-driven rebound

Economic outlook	The IMF expects growth of only 0.6% in 2026, with unemployment around 9.5%, followed by a rebound to 2.6% in 2027. Inflation is forecast to ease to 3.7% in 2026.
Policy direction	The Kast government's economic reform, approved by Congress in August 2026, gradually cuts corporate income tax from 27% to 23%, freezes tax conditions for 20 years for investments above US$350 million and aims to remove permitting barriers.
Key opportunities	Copper and lithium mining technology, renewable energy and green hydrogen, data centers in Santiago, salmon and aquaculture technology, water and desalination, financial services and B2B software.
Why it matters	Chile's institutional stability, legal certainty and network of trade and tax treaties make it the natural **regional headquarters and test market** for companies expanding across Latin America.

PERU Steady growth, mining and Asia gateway

Economic outlook	The IMF raised its 2026 forecast to 3.0%, the strongest among the five markets, with 2.9% expected in 2027. Peru combines growth with one of the lowest inflation rates in the region.
Policy direction	Keiko Fujimori took office in July 2026 after a narrow runoff victory. Business expectations focus on investment promotion, mining project approvals and institutional stability.
Key opportunities	Copper and polymetallic mining services, agro-export technology and logistics, port and logistics services around the new Chancay megaport, infrastructure, and digital financial services (Yape alone reports 16.4 million monthly active users).
Why it matters	A growing, young market with strong mining and agro-export cash flows, where foreign technology and specialized services are in demand.

ARGENTINA High upside, high volatility

Economic outlook	The IMF cut its 2026 forecast to 2.1% but expects 3.5% in 2027. Average inflation is still forecast at 32.5% in 2026, so pricing and currency strategy are critical.
Policy direction	The Large Investment Incentive Regime (RIGI) had approved 16 projects worth about US$29.9 billion by June 2026, out of a pipeline of 41 projects worth US$140.9 billion, mainly in mining, oil and gas and energy.
Key opportunities	Suppliers and technology for Vaca Muerta oil and gas, lithium and copper projects, energy infrastructure, agribusiness technology, and partnerships with Argentina's highly skilled tech talent.
Why it matters	One of the largest investment waves in the region. Early positioning with project developers and their contractors can open long-term supply relationships.

COLOMBIA Digital and services hub in transition

Economic outlook	The IMF projects growth of 2.2% in 2026 and 2.3% in 2027, with inflation near 6% and fiscal pressures limiting room for policy support.
Policy direction	Abelardo de la Espriella took office on 7 August 2026. Investors expect a more market-oriented agenda, while fiscal consolidation remains a priority.
Key opportunities	Fintech and digital payments (the Bre-B instant-payment system moved more than COP 262 trillion in its first year, with 36 million users), BPO and IT services, energy transition, agribusiness, logistics and healthcare.
Why it matters	A large, entrepreneurial and well-connected market with strong hubs in Bogotá and Medellín and fast adoption of new digital financial solutions.

MEXICO	Scale, manufacturing and North America link
Economic outlook	The IMF expects 1.5% growth in 2026 and 1.8% in 2027. Growth is modest, but the market's scale remains unmatched in Spanish-speaking Latin America.
Policy direction	At the July 2026 USMCA joint review, the United States did not confirm a 16-year extension, which triggers annual reviews. The agreement remains fully in force until at least 2036, but investors are more cautious.
Key opportunities	Industrial automation and Industry 4.0, automotive, electronics and medical devices supply chains, data centers in Querétaro, energy, logistics, retail and e-commerce (37% of internet users already buy online).
Why it matters	The largest Spanish-speaking B2B market and the main manufacturing gateway to North America; essential for companies seeking scale.

Opportunity map by sector

Relative attractiveness for foreign B2B companies, based on market size, investment flows and demand for imported technology (●●● high, ●● medium, ● selective).

Sector	Chile	Peru	Argentina	Colombia	Mexico
Mining & critical minerals tech	●●●	●●●	●●●	●	●●
Energy transition & renewables	●●●	●●	●●●	●●	●●
Manufacturing & Industry 4.0	●	●	●●	●●	●●●
Fintech & digital payments	●●	●●	●●	●●●	●●●
Data centers & cloud services	●●●	●	●●	●●	●●●
Agrifood, aquaculture & water	●●●	●●●	●●	●●	●●
Logistics & infrastructure	●●	●●●	●●	●●	●●●

Which market first? Entry logic by company profile

If your company offers…	Recommended entry market	Why
Mining, water or decarbonization technology	Chile → Peru	Highest concentration of copper and lithium operators, sophisticated buyers and regional mining headquarters in Santiago and Lima.
Oil & gas, lithium or energy infrastructure	Argentina	RIGI projects are moving from approval to construction and need suppliers, engineering and technology partners.
Industrial automation, Industry 4.0 or supply-chain solutions	Mexico	Largest manufacturing base, linked to North American supply chains and nearshoring programs.
Fintech, payments, SaaS or B2B software	Colombia or Mexico, with Chile as test market	Fast digital adoption, large mid-market and active financial-sector modernization.
Agritech, aquaculture or food technology	Chile and Peru	World-class agro-export and salmon industries with strong export orientation and openness to innovation.

Risks to manage from day one

- **Currency and inflation:** price in USD where possible, index contracts and plan cash conversion, especially in Argentina and Colombia.
- **Political and regulatory transitions:** four of the five markets have new or recently reformed policy frameworks; track rules closely and build local relationships with industry associations.
- **Trade uncertainty:** in Mexico, annual USMCA reviews mean supply-chain and rules-of-origin decisions should include scenario planning.
- **Long sales cycles and payment terms:** large corporates can take 6 to 18 months to decide and 60 to 90 days to pay; pilots and phased contracts reduce risk.

Signals to watch in 2027

Market	What to monitor	Why it matters for foreign companies
Chile	Implementation of the 2026 tax and permitting reform	Faster permits and lower taxes should unlock delayed mining, energy and infrastructure projects.
Peru	Mining project approvals under the new government	Approvals translate directly into demand for equipment, services and technology.
Argentina	RIGI projects moving into construction; inflation path	Construction phases open supplier opportunities; disinflation improves pricing conditions.
Colombia	Fiscal plan and energy policy of the new government	Sets the tone for investment in energy, infrastructure and financial services.
Mexico	Annual USMCA review (July 2027) and nearshoring flows	Determines the pace of manufacturing investment and supplier development.

Key takeaway

Each market offers a different entry logic: **Chile** as a stable test market and regional hub, **Peru** for mining and steady growth, **Argentina** for the RIGI investment wave, **Colombia** for digital and services, and **Mexico** for scale and manufacturing. The winning strategy is usually to enter one or two markets first and expand from a regional base.

HOW WIDDEX BDP CAN HELP

From opportunity to first revenue

Widdex BDP helps innovative foreign companies turn Latin American opportunities into real revenue through a hands-on, six-step path: market opportunity assessment, go-to-market strategy, first clients and pilots, local setup, a fractional strategy director and a turn-key Fractional HQ in Chile. Our C-level team and network across Mexico, Colombia, Argentina, Peru and Chile give you direct access to decision-makers in the sectors where demand is growing. The benefits are clear: **a faster path to revenue**, **lower capital at risk** because you validate demand before hiring a permanent team or opening a subsidiary, **a prioritized market choice backed by local data**, and **a scalable regional platform** from Chile with legal domicile, corporate banking and multi-country coordination.

Let's talk Francisco Amigo, Managing Partner · www.widdex.com · linkedin.com/in/franciscoamigog

Sources & notes

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